

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 3
 ♥ K Q J 10
 ♦ Q J 10 2
 ♣ 10 7 3

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ 9 5 2

♦ K 9

♣ 9 8 6 2



♠ 10 8
 ♥ A 6 4 3
 ♦ 8 5 4 3
 ♣ A K J

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ A 7 6

♣ Q 5 4

SOUTH has an opening hand, 15 points, and a 5-card ♠ suit. Unfortunately EAST beat her to the punch by opening 1♥.

But SOUTH should get into the bidding anyway, by Overcalling 1♠. This shows a good ♠ suit and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

NORTH has 6 points. If SOUTH had actually OPENED 1♠, NORTH would be obligated to bid. But knowing that the Overcall will not be made with more than 16 points, NORTH just passes.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

1♠

All Pass

1♠ by South

Lead: ♦Q

Board 2

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8
 ♥ A K J 9
 ♦ J 9 8
 ♣ 8 7 3 2

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ 10 5 2

♦ K Q 4

♣ K J 6



♠ 5 3

♥ Q 6 4 3

♦ 10 5 3 2

♣ A 10 9

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ A 7 6

♣ Q 5 4

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1 ♥	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥K			

SOUTH has an opening hand, 15 points and five ♠s.
 But EAST beat him to the punch, so he overcalls 1 ♠.

NORTH has 11 points, and if SOUTH had opened
 she would make a Limit Raise to 3 ♠.

But when replying to an Overcall, the strength needs
 to be a little higher. In Deal 1 it was OK to pass a 1 ♠
 Overcall with 6 points, here it is correct to just raise
 to 2 ♠ with 11 points.

SOUTH actually has a strong Overcall so he bids
 4 ♠.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 5 3
 ♥ A K J 3
 ♦ Q 10 3 2
 ♣ A 9 3

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ 10 5 2

♦ A K

♣ K 8 6 2



♠ 10 8
 ♥ Q 9 6 4
 ♦ J 8 5 4
 ♣ Q 10 7

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ 9 7 6

♣ J 5 4

This time SOUTH has just 10 points, nowhere near an opening hand. Still, when EAST opens 1♥ SOUTH should Overcall 1♠. This shows a good ♠ suit and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

NORTH has 13 points. If SOUTH had actually OPENED 1♠, NORTH would insist on game. But SOUTH didn't Open, she just Overcalled. So NORTH must be more cautious. He jumps to 3♠ and SOUTH shows her minimum type hand by passing.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

1♠

Pass

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by South

Lead: ♥A

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

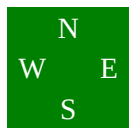
♠ 7 4 2
♥ Q 9 8 2
♦ 9 6 4 2
♣ J 10

♠ K 9 8 6

♥ 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ K Q 7 5



♠ Q J

♥ A K J 6 3

♦ J 10 5

♣ 9 4 3

♠ A 10 5 3

♥ 10 7 5

♦ Q 8

♣ A 8 6 2

NORTH has 15 points, a singleton in the opponent's suit and 4-card support for any suit partner might name. In other words, a perfect Takeout Double.

SOUTH needs to make a medium-strong bid to apprise NORTH of her 10 points. She jumps to 2 ♠.

NORTH's hand is now worth 17 points because of the singleton. Since he is quite happy with ♠s he bids 4 ♠.

West

1 ♥

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by South

Lead: ♦ 4

North

Dbl

4 ♠

East

Pass

South

2 ♠

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 8

♥ K Q 5

♦ 9 7 5 2

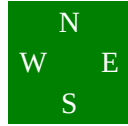
♣ A 6 3

♠ 5 3

♥ A J 4 2

♦ K Q J

♣ K 7 4 2



♠ A K J 9

♥ 10 9 8

♦ A 10 3

♣ Q 10 5

♠ 7 6 4 2

♥ 7 6 3

♦ 8 6 4

♣ J 9 8

West

1 ♠

All Pass

2 ♣ by South

Lead: ♥ K

North

Dbl

East

Pass

South

2 ♣

NORTH has 14 points, a doubleton in the opponent's ♠ suit and at least three cards in each of the other suits. This is a normal Takeout Double.

SOUTH has a really awful hand. He has just one point and his only 4-card suit is the one the opponents have already bid. He wants nothing more than to pass.

But he cannot pass. Partner's Double said "Bid your best suit.", so he bids 2 ♣.

Mercifully NORTH also passes.

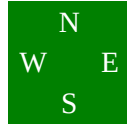
Board 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 4 3 2
 ♥ A 6 2
 ♦ 7 4 2
 ♣ Q J 9 5

♠ Q 9 8 5
 ♥ K Q 10 5
 ♦ A K 3
 ♣ 4 2



♠ K 6
 ♥ 9 8 4 3
 ♦ 10 8 6
 ♣ K 10 7 6

♠ A J 10 7
 ♥ J 7
 ♦ Q J 9 5
 ♣ A 8 3

With 14 points, ♣ shortage, and support for the other suits NORTH makes a Takeout Double.

SOUTH has 13 points so she bids 2♣. This is an artificial bid, apprising NORTH of SOUTH's opening hand strength, and forcing the partnership to reach the game level.

NORTH suggests ♥s as trumps. SOUTH doesn't like ♥s so she suggests ♠s. NORTH agrees with ♠s and bids game, 4♠.

West	North	East	South
1♣	Dbl	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♣Q			

Board 7

West Deals

None Vul

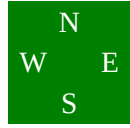
♠ 6 2
 ♥ A 10 8 4
 ♦ 10 8 2
 ♣ K J 4 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ 9 6 5 2

♦ Q 5

♣ A 8 6 3



♠ 10 5

♥ K Q J 3

♦ 9 7 6 4

♣ Q 10 9

♠ A K J 9 8 3

♥ 7

♦ A K J 3

♣ 7 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	Pass	Pass	Dbl
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♠ 2			

WEST's 1 ♥ opening is passed around to SOUTH.
 He is tempted to overcall 1 ♠, but with 18 points is a little strong for a mere overcall. Instead, he doubles.

With 8 points NORTH is not strong enough to jump.
 She bids 2 ♣.

SOUTH now bids 2 ♠. By doubling first, then bidding his own suit, he shows a good suit and 17+ points.

NORTH raises to 4 ♠.

Board 8

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K 6 5 4

♥ J 10 4

♦ K 10 9

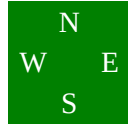
♣ J 10 2

♠ 8 7

♥ A 9 7 6

♦ A 6 2

♣ K 9 6 3



♠ Q 10 3 2

♥ 5 3 2

♦ J 8 5 3

♣ 7 4

♠ A J 9

♥ K Q 8

♦ Q 7 4

♣ A Q 8 5

SOUTH has 18 points, a balanced hand, and a good stopper in their suit. He should overcall 1NT. For 1NT overcalls, the range is increased to 15-18 points.

NORTH bids 2♣ (Stayman), just as she would with a 1NT opening. When SOUTH denies holding a 4-card Major NORTH has enough points to bid 3NT. She doesn't worry about a ♠ stopper since SOUTH promised he had the suit controlled.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1 ♠	1NT
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♠ 4			

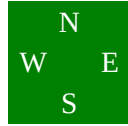
Board 9

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 7 4 3
♥ A 8 3
♦ 5 4 3 2
♣ 10 7 5

♠ J 10 5 2
♥ 7 6 4 2
♦ 8 6
♣ J 8 6



♠ K Q 9
♥ 10 9 5
♦ K Q 10
♣ A 9 3 2

♠ A 8 6
♥ K Q J
♦ A J 9 7
♣ K Q 4

SOUTH has 20 points, excellent ♦ stoppers and a balanced hand. She is two points too strong to overcall 1NT. Instead, she doubles.

NORTH has an awful hand - but since he is forced to bid he says 1♠, assuming SOUTH wants to hear his best suit.

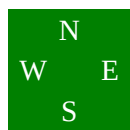
SOUTH now bids 1NT, showing the balanced 19-21 point hand. NORTH passes, of course.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1♦	Dbl
Pass	1♠	Pass	1NT
All Pass			
1NT by South			
Lead: ♦ 4			

Board 10
 East Deals
 None Vul

♠ 9 8 5
 ♥ K J 8 2
 ♦ 8 6 4
 ♣ J 10 3

♠ K J 6 2
 ♥ 6 5
 ♦ A Q 3
 ♣ 9 8 7 4



♠ A 10 3
 ♥ 9 7 4 3
 ♦ 10 9 2
 ♣ Q 5 2

♠ Q 7 4
 ♥ A Q 10
 ♦ K J 7 5
 ♣ A K 6

SOUTH has a 19 point balanced hand, including a stop in ♥s. He plans to double, then bid NT. (see Deal 9)

NORTH has 10 points though, so he jumps to 2♠.

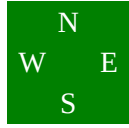
In theory SOUTH could now bid 2NT to continue the description of his hand, but he might as well go ahead and bid 3NT instead.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1♥	Dbl
Pass	2♠	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥2			

Board 11
 East Deals
 None Vul

♠ 8 6
 ♥ K 7 3 2
 ♦ A 8 7 6
 ♣ 10 8 3

♠ K J 4 2
 ♥ A 8 5
 ♦ K J 3 2
 ♣ J 2



♠ 9 7
 ♥ Q J 10 9
 ♦ 9 5 4
 ♣ K Q 6 5

♠ A Q 10 5 3
 ♥ 6 4
 ♦ Q 10
 ♣ A 9 7 4

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1 ♥	1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥ 3			

With a 5-card ♠ suit and 13 points SOUTH should overcall 1 ♠.

NORTH has 13 points and four ♠s. If SOUTH had opened, NORTH's hand would be good enough to insist on game. But since SOUTH overcalled, NORTH merely invites with a jump to 3 ♠.

SOUTH has better than a minimum overcall so she accepts the invitation and bids 4 ♠.

Board 12

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 9 8 2
♥ A
♦ K 10 8 4 3
♣ 8 4 2

♠ K J 6 4

♥ J 10 7 5

♦ 6

♣ A K J 3



♠ A 7 5

♥ 3 2

♦ Q J 9 7

♣ Q 10 7 6

♠ Q 3

♥ K Q 9 8 6 4

♦ A 5 2

♣ 9 5

NORTH has a very minimum Takeout Double of 1♦. But what it lacks in strength, it makes up for with perfect distribution.

SOUTH has 13 points and only wants to play in one contract, 4♥.

NORTH passes happily.

West

1♦

North

Dbl

East

Pass

South

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♠10

Board 13
West Deals
None Vul

♠ K 5 2
♥ A 9 8
♦ K 5 2
♣ J 9 8 7

♠ A 10 9 4
♥ K Q J 7
♦ Q 6
♣ A Q 4



♠ Q 8 3
♥ 6 4 3
♦ 10 8 7 3
♣ 6 5 3

♠ J 7 6
♥ 10 5 2
♦ A J 9 4
♣ K 10 2

NORTH has 18 points, a doubleton in the opponent's suit, and at least three cards in the unbid suits. This is an ideal hand for a Takeout Double.

SOUTH has good strength in WEST's ♦ suit, probably two stoppers. He has 9 points and no 4-card suit of his own. This is the type of hand to respond 1NT.

NORTH is happy to play Notrump now that she knows the ♦s are covered, so she bids 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
1 ♦	Dbl	Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥9			

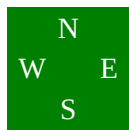
Board 14

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 7 5
 ♥ K 10 7 6
 ♦ 10 9 2
 ♣ A 5 4

♠ A K 9 6 4
 ♥ Q 5
 ♦ K 7 4
 ♣ J 10 7



♠ J 3 2
 ♥ 8 4 3
 ♦ Q 8 5 3
 ♣ K 6 2

♠ Q 8
 ♥ A J 9 2
 ♦ A J 6
 ♣ Q 9 8 3

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	1 ♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♣5			

NORTH has an opening hand, 14 points and five ♠s. But WEST beat him to the punch, so he overcalls 1 ♠.

SOUTH also has 14 points, she doesn't care too much for ♠s, but she has an excellent stopper in ♥s. She jumps to 2NT, inviting NORTH to bid game.

Since NORTH has several points more than he might have had, and no 6-card ♠ suit to rebid, he happily bids 3NT.

Board 15

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 6 2

♥ A 8 2

♦ 9 4 2

♣ 9 3 2

♠ A 9 3

♥ J 10 5 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A K 8 6



♠ J 10 5 4

♥ 6 4

♦ J 10 7 6

♣ 10 7 5

♠ 8 7

♥ K Q 9 7

♦ A K 8 3

♣ Q J 4

SOUTH has 15 points and all the requirements for a Takeout Double of 1♠.

With 14 points of his own, NORTH knows his side needs to be in a game somewhere. He passes this information to SOUTH with a cue-bid of 2♠.

SOUTH gets the message and starts the hunt for a trump fit by bidding 3♥. That makes it easy for NORTH - he bids 4♥.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1♠	Dbl
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♠K			

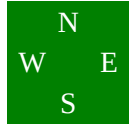
Board 16

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 3
 ♥ Q J 10 4
 ♦ A 9 4
 ♣ K Q 10 5

♠ K 7 5
 ♥ 8 5 2
 ♦ K Q 3
 ♣ 9 7 6 2



♠ 10 9
 ♥ K 9 6 3
 ♦ 10 8 6 5
 ♣ J 4 3

♠ A Q J 6 4 2
 ♥ A 7
 ♦ J 7 2
 ♣ A 8

There is only one reason that SOUTH should not overcall with 1 ♠. He is too strong. The maximum strength of an overcall is 16 points. Above that you should double.

So SOUTH doubles, and after NORTH bids 2 ♣, SOUTH bids 2 ♠. This shows an overcall type hand, but with 17 or more points.

NORTH has fine trump support and 8 points so she bids a confident 4 ♠.

West	North	East	South
		1 ♥	Dbl
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥ Q			

Board 17

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 5 4
 ♥ J 10 9 2
 ♦ J 10 8 6
 ♣ 5 3

♠ Q J 2

♥ A K 4 3

♦ 7 4

♣ K Q 8 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 7 6

♥ Q 8 5

♦ A 9 3 2

♣ 10 9 4

♠ K 9 8 3

♥ 7 6

♦ K Q 5

♣ A J 7 6

SOUTH has 13 points but has no bid over 1 ♦.

NORTH can make a Takeout Double, so he does.

SOUTH now cue-bids ♦ to show opening hand strength.

NORTH shows his ♥ suit, SOUTH doesn't like it.

SOUTH shows her ♠ suit, NORTH doesn't like it.

NORTH shows his ♣ suit, SOUTH likes it fine, but decides 3NT will be easier than 5♣.

West	North	East	South
		1 ♦	Pass
Pass	Dbl	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	3 ♣	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♦ J			

Board 18

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A J 10 7 4

♥ A 7 3

♦ A 8 6

♣ 9 5

♠ Q 5 3

♥ 9 8 4

♦ 10 3 2

♣ A J 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 6

♥ Q 6 5

♦ J 7 5 4

♣ K 10 6 2

♠ K 8 2

♥ K J 10 2

♦ K Q 9

♣ Q 8 3

WEST would have had a great opening 1♠ bid. But when SOUTH opened 1♠ in front of him he was hornswaggled. He couldn't bid any other suit, he couldn't bid 1NT and he sure couldn't bid ♠s. So he must pass.

And so does everybody else pass.

*West**North**East**South*

1♠

All Pass

1♠ by South

Lead: ♣9

Board 19

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 4
♥ K 9 6 3
♦ A 4 2
♣ A K J 9

♠ A 8 2

♥ J 5 2

♦ K 9 8 6

♣ 7 5 3



♠ 6

♥ A Q 10 8

♦ J 10 7 5

♣ Q 10 8 4

♠ K Q J 9 7 5 3

♥ 7 4

♦ Q 3

♣ 6 2

If East had passed, SOUTH would have opened with a preemptive 3♠.

She should make the same bid with the same hand AFTER the opponents open. And she makes it for the same reason, to describe her hand and to take away bidding space from the opponents.

NORTH treats it just like a Preemptive 3-bid, even though it is now called a Weak Jump Overcall. In this case, NORTH passes.

*West**North**East**South*

1♣

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by South

Lead: ♣K

Board 20

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 4
♥ 10 9 8 2
♦ K Q 7
♣ K Q J 2

♠ K 7 2
♥ Q J 5 4
♦ 6 3
♣ 9 8 6 4



♠ 9 6 3
♥ A K 7
♦ 9 4 2
♣ A 10 7 5

♠ A J 10 8 5
♥ 6 3
♦ A J 10 8 5
♣ 3

SOUTH has 12 points, but with two 5-card suits worthy of an overcall. There isn't really a right and wrong here, but it usually works out best to overcall in the higher-ranking suit. That leaves open the possibility of bidding the second suit later.

In this Deal, after SOUTH overcalls 1♠, that later possibility never happens because everybody should pass.

West	North	East	South
		1♣	1♠

All Pass

1♠ by South

Lead: ♣K

Board 21

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 5 3
♥ 4 2
♦ A K 2
♣ J 7 6 4 2

♠ K 10 7 4

♥ K J 7

♦ 10 7 6

♣ A Q 3



♠ Q 8 6

♥ Q 8 6 3

♦ 9 8 4 3

♣ 8 5

♠ J 9 2

♥ A 10 9 5

♦ Q J 5

♣ K 10 9

WEST has 13 points but she has to pass. She cannot Double without support for ♥s. She cannot bid 1NT without 2 more points. She cannot overcall 2♣ with a terrible suit like that.

And EAST of course must also pass.

*West**North**East**South*

1♠

All Pass

1♠ by South

Lead: ♦K

Board 22

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q J 8 4 2

♥ Q 2

♦ Q 8 7

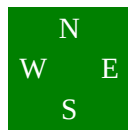
♣ 8 3

♠ A 6

♥ 9 8 4 3

♦ 6 3 2

♣ K 6 5 4



♠ 10 3

♥ K J 7 6

♦ K J 5

♣ A Q 7 2

♠ 9 7 5

♥ A 10 5

♦ A 10 9 4

♣ J 10 9

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

Pass

Dbl

All Pass

1 ♠ by South

Lead: ♣8

WEST obviously has to pass when SOUTH opens 1 ♠.

EAST has a reasonable Takeout Double. She hopes WEST will name a suit and they can just play a partscore.

You should almost always bid when partner makes a Takeout Double. Almost always. This is the one time when you don't. WEST's ♠ are so good that he passes, converting the Takeout Double into a Penalty Double.

Board 23

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 6 3
♥ 6 5 3
♦ J 10 3
♣ A J 9 8

♠ Q J 5

♥ A K Q 2

♦ A 9 8 5

♣ 4 2



♠ 10 4

♥ 10 7 4

♦ Q 4 2

♣ K Q 10 7 3

♠ A K 8 7 2

♥ J 9 8

♦ K 7 6

♣ 6 5

SOUTH has a normal overcall of 1 ♠.

NORTH has a really good hand, but he doesn't have to worry about missing a slam since SOUTH will not have more than 16 points. So he just bids what he thinks SOUTH can make, 4 ♠.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♣

1 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by South

Lead: ♥ 3

Board 24

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A J 8 4

♥ 10 9 7

♦ A 8 4

♣ K 7 2

♠ K Q 3

♥ K Q J 5 3

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 10 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 7 2

♥ A 6 2

♦ Q 7 2

♣ Q 9 5 3

♠ 10 6 5

♥ 8 4

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A J 8 4

NORTH has 12 points and a good enough suit to overcall 1 ♥.

SOUTH has 9 points with a good ♦ stopper. She bids 1NT.

NORTH has nothing more to say, and lets SOUTH play 1NT.

West

1 ♦

North

1 ♥

East

Pass

South

1NT

All Pass

1NT by South

Lead: ♠4